

characteristics; most commonly heard in folk music and **plainsong**.

motet

A **polyphonic** choral composition based on a sacred text, usually unaccompanied.

nocturne

“Night piece.” As a solo, one-movement piano piece, the nocturne originated with John Field, but was developed to a great degree by Chopin.

octave

The interval between one **pitch** and another with double or half its frequency; on a piano there is an octave between high C and the next-highest C note.

opera

A drama in which all or most characters sing and in which music is an important element; usually all dialogue is sung.

opera buffa

A type of comic **opera** that became popular in the 18th century; the opposite of opera seria.

opéra comique

An exclusively French type of **opera** that, despite its